Xudong Zhu

PhD Candidate in International History
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Education

Mar. 2025 – Present	PhD Candidate, International History, **University of Aberdeen**, Aberdeen, UK. Dissertation: *Strategy-Making in a Fragmented State: Security Policy, Defence Policy, and Grand Strategy in Sino-German Cooperation (1928–1938)*. Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Thomas Weber; Dr. Andrew Dilley. Fields: applied history, grand strategy, global security.
Oct. 2021 – Aug. 2023	MA, American Studies (Political Science and History track), **Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg**, Heidelberg, Germany. Thesis: *On the Theory of Empire in International Relations and an Analysis of Pax Americana*. Selected courses: US economic policy, the transatlantic alliance, nuclear deterrence theory, political psychology, and varieties of American conservatism.
Sep. 2017 – Jun. 2021	LLB, Diplomacy, **Jilin University**, Changchun, China. Selected courses: international history, theories of international relations, foreign policy analysis, international law, power politics, and political philosophy.

Professional Memberships

2025 – Present	Postgraduate Member, Royal Historical Society.
2025 – Present	Member, Association of Chinese Political Studies.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Book Chapter

2026. "How to Maintain a Balance in the Intricate *Pas de Trois* among China, US and EU" (with Wang Li). In *The Trilateral Interactions: China, the US, and the EU on Tensions, Competition, and Cooperation*, edited by Zuokui Liu, Marek Hrubec, and Shaohua Yan. London: Routledge. doi:10.4324/9781003736554-8.

Prize Essay

2025. "Trump as the (In)advertent Harbinger of a New Transatlantic Security Architecture: Europe's Autonomy as a Bulwark Against Chinese Influence". *Runner-up, Jimmy Carter Prize, China Focus Essay Contest*, by the Carter Center, in cooperation with the University of California, San Diego, and the 1990 Institute.

Conference Papers

2026. "Bypassing the Diplomats: Bureaucratic Politics and the Formulation of Sino-German Strategic Cooperation, 1928–1930". *British International History Group (BIHG) Annual Conference 2026*, Loughborough University.

2025. "Beyond Divide and Rule: Advocating a Respect-Based Chinese Policy Toward the European Union". *Annual Conference of the Association of Chinese Political Studies (ACPS)*, King's College London.

2022. "What to Do About the Strategic Challenge? An Analysis of the Background of NATO's New China Strategy". *Seventh Annual Young Scholars Forum on US–China Relations*, The Carter Center.

Public Engagement

2026. "The Washington Summit Shows That US–China Relations Require a Firmer Foundation than the Relationship between Its Two Leaders". *LSE US Politics and Policy (USAPP) Blog*, 2 October 2026.

2026. "Improving U.S.–China Relations: Ten Thousand Years Is Too Long; Seize the Day". *US–China Perception Monitor*, 18 May 2026.

2026. [A Peaceful Rise? Analysing Germany's *Gesamtkonzeption der militärischen Verteidigung*]. *US–China Perception Monitor* (Chinese edition), 05 May 2026. In Chinese.

2026. [Towards Europe's Strongest Conventional Armed Force: *Gesamtkonzeption der militärischen Verteidigung*]. *US–China Perception Monitor* (Chinese edition), 30 April 2026. In Chinese.

2025. [If Bismarck Ran Washington: What Approach Would He Take to U.S.–China Relations?]. *US–China Perception Monitor* (Chinese edition), 11 December 2025. In Chinese.

2025. [From *The Art of the Deal* to The Art of Diplomacy: The Continuities in Trump's View of International Relations]. *US–China Perception Monitor* (Chinese edition), 11 September 2025. In Chinese.

Ongoing Project

In preparation. *Das politische System Chinas* (with Dr. Björn Alexander Düben). Baden-Baden: Nomos. Under contract; all twelve chapters drafted, manuscript now being edited. In German.

Teaching

2026/27	Tutor, University of Aberdeen, Aberdeen, UK. *HI1022: Europe in the Twentieth Century* *HI356J: Thinking History* (honours course)
2025/26	Tutor, University of Aberdeen, Aberdeen, UK. *HI1022: Europe in the Twentieth Century* *HI2520: Global Empire in the Long Nineteenth Century*
2023	Tutor, Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg, Heidelberg, Germany. *From Washington to Peking: A History of Early Interactions Between the US and China*

Professional and Research Experience

2025 – Present	Contributing Writer, US–China Perception Monitor, The Carter Center (remote). Write analysis in English and Chinese on US–China relations, European security, and transatlantic strategy (see Public Engagement).
Jun. – Aug. 2025	Research Intern, Experience, Engagement & Wellbeing Team, University of Aberdeen, Aberdeen, UK. Conducted qualitative research on international students' study journeys across undergraduate, postgraduate-taught, and ISC/Language Centre cohorts; produced strategy roadmaps to enhance the student experience. Coordinated communication across academic and professional-services departments and contributed to orientation materials for incoming international students.

Jun. – Sep. 2020	Academic Assistant, US–China Perception Monitor, The Carter Center (remote). Translated and edited articles on US–China relations for the centre's bilingual platform. Co-organised eight academic conferences and authored proceedings summaries. Interviewed policy scholars and wrote articles averaging over 5,000 readers.

Awards

2025	Runner-up, Jimmy Carter Prize, China Focus Essay Contest
2018	Excellence Award, 16th National Diplomatic Etiquette Competition

Grants and Funding

2025	Postgraduate Research Funding (£148), School of Divinity, History, Philosophy and Art History, University of Aberdeen, to present a paper at the Annual Conference of the Association of Chinese Political Studies (ACPS), King's College London.

Digital Humanities Projects

2026	*BismAI: A Bismarck-Persona Fine-Tune of Gemma 4 E4B*, developer. LoRA fine-tune of Google's Gemma 4 E4B Instruct base model, trained to adopt the rhetorical and strategic voice of Otto von Bismarck for historical-persona research and teaching. huggingface.co/Ottomin/BismAI-V2

Service

2018 – 2021	Moderator, Academic Forum, School of International and Public Affairs (SIPA), Jilin University.
2018	Research assistant to Professor Swaran Singh (Jawaharlal Nehru University) during his visit to Jilin University.

Languages

Mandarin (native); English (fluent); German (fluent)